Prince of Kung
to Mr. Wade.

Incl. 2
in Mr. Wade's No. 194
of 16 Sept. 1874

Peking,
16th September, 1874.

No. 195

My Lord:

Okubo, the High Commissioner of Japan, arrived here a few days ago. He was lodged at Tientsin in the American Consulate, and during his stay there, I believe, paid no visit to the Governor-General Li Hung-chang. He was received by the Prince of Kung at the Tsung-li Yamên on the 14th, and

The Earl of Derby
&c. &c. &c.

PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE
1 2 3 4 5 6
Reference:— F.O. 17 675
COPYRIGHT PHOTOGRAPH—NOT TO BE REPRODUCED PHOTOGRAPHICALLY WITHOUT PERMISSION OF THE PUBLIC RECORD OFFICE, LONDON

and paid his visits to the Legations the following day.

I returned his call this afternoon, and, the usual commonplaces disposed of, I begged permission, as I should have to close my despatches to your Lordship on the 18th, the day after tomorrow, to ask him what prospect there was of a settlement of the question open between the governments of China and Japan. I premised, I should observe,

that

that Sir Harry Parkes had understood the Secretary for Foreign Affairs at Yedo to say that if China were prepared to occupy the stations now held by Japanese troops, and to justify the action taken by the Japanese against the Formosans, the Government of Japan was prepared to withdraw its forces from Formosa.

The High Commissioner smilingly observed that there was a slight difference between this undertaking and the instructions he had received; and in reply

to

to a farther question he stated that there was no word of withdrawing the troops. I asked if he proposed to pass the winter at Peking. He said he trusted not; his desire was to settle the matter he was sent about satisfactorily, and to return as soon as he could to Japan. The Minister Yanagiwara would remain. All this most blandly and pleasantly, but with a manifest reluctance to go farther into the question than could

could be avoided.

The Minister Yanagiwara is still in search of a Legation. Indeed, I have heard that he has rented or purchased a building to be converted into a residence for the mission.

I should add that I excused the pertinacity of my inquiries regarding the Formosan question by the plea that, until it is settled, things here are in such a state of disquiet that

that our interests, which are large, cannot fail to be prejudiced by it, and that, for the greater security of these, I had telegraphed home to recommend that our squadron in these seas should be reinforced.

I have the honor to be,
My Lord,
with the highest respect,
Your Lordship's most
humble obedient Servant,
Thomas Francis Wade

1874.
Peking, Sept 16th.
Mr. Wade
No 195

Received Nov 14

Japanese High Commissioner Okubo arrived. Received by Prince of Kung. Visits exchanged and conversation respecting state of affairs.

To the Queen
Mr Disraeli
Circulate

583

~~347~~ 350

Peking,
16th September 1874.

No. 196

My Lord:

In my telegram of the 11th inst. I informed Your Lordship of my intention to meet Sir Charles Shadwell at Shanghai, early in October. I doubt much that I shall be able to effect this. M. de Geofroy will not be back from Chefoo for some days, and when he arrives M. de Bützow, who starts for Mongolia

The Earl of Derby
etc. etc. etc.